PORTLAND
Public Schools

Board of Education

Due Diligence Update
One North Property
Center for Black Student Excellence

11/18/25

“The **Beloved Community** is not some utopia, it is the real world we can build when we live by love and justice.”

-Representative John Lewis

A Living Expression of Beloved Community

In our developing framework, Birth to Brilliance, the Center for Black Student Excellence is anchored in **Beloved Community**. The Center embodies one of the core principles of what we call thrivability, where power, partnership, and belonging take physical form.

Love is our infrastructure.

The **CBSE Vision** is values, and outcomes-based, it defines what this space must accomplish. The **Feasibility Study** translates those aspirations into spatial and functional possibilities.

Each program area transforms values into place. Each hub becomes a manifestation of Beloved Community, connection, creativity, and collective care in action.



Site Overview: One North Property

3506 - 3514 N Vancouver Ave. and 25 N. Fremont PDX | OR

Year Completed: 2015

Buildings: 2

Approximate Building Size:
East Bldg 37,900 SF | West Bldg 37,800 SF
Total SF: 75,700

Zoning: CM3

Central NE Portland; deep cultural relevance for Black Portlanders

Flexible space for implementing community Vision.



Michael Chappie Grice Center (East)

The East building (**Chappie East**) is envisioned as a convergence point for student-focused gatherings, community-oriented organizations, and workspaces.

Chappie East is envisioned as the living room of the Center for Black Student Excellence, the place where students, families, elders, and community partners converge.

It will be an open invitation: a space where learning is surrounded by belonging.

Design Intent: The East Building should feel like a village living room, vibrant, caring, and full of cultural connection.

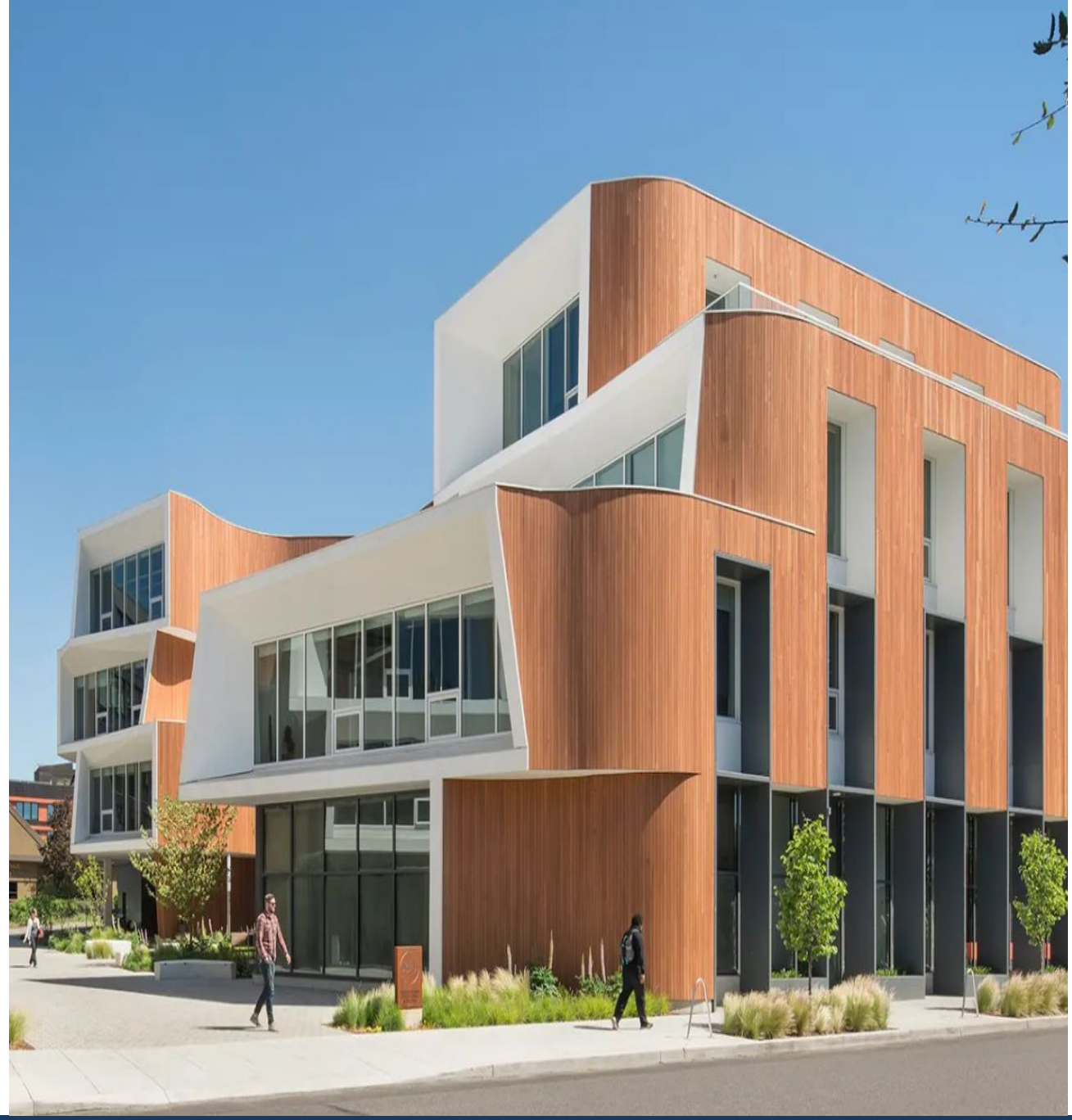


Dr. Harriet Adair Center (West)

The West Building (**Adair West**) is dedicated to the pursuit of academic brilliance, imagination, and innovation. It embodies the spirit of Dr. Harriet Adair: A legacy of scholarship, leadership, and unwavering belief in the potential of every student.

Adair West stands as the studio of brilliance. A space where curiosity is cultivated, ideas are born, and learning becomes a creative act. Here, students engage in design, technology, and artistry that reflect both intellect and imagination.

Design Intent: Adair West should feel like a creative engine, dynamic, forward-looking, and filled with the energy of students shaping the future they deserve.



Conceptual Fit

- A feasibility study was conducted by Adre in partnership with Lever Architects. Their conceptual test fit of the CBSE Vision has confirmed the program functions will fit comfortably in One North with room for community partner space.
    - Center for Arts and Culture - A living museum and cultural studio, where Black culture, art, and history are preserved, celebrated, and reimagined for future generations
    - Event Center - The soul of community gathering, elegant, warm, and unmistakably rooted in Black culture and hospitality. It is a space where education meets celebration, designed for shared meals, cultural performances, professional learning, and district convenings that honor belonging as a form of brilliance.
    - Leadership Hub - Support the people and partnerships who steward this work, those leading, researching, art residencies and coordinating programs that bring Beloved Community to life

TOGETHER, WE RISE
WITH EXCELLENCE. WITH PURPOSE.

Conceptual Fit



- Resource Hub - Connection between the public realm and the innovation work happening throughout the building.
- Innovation Studio - Bring together students, educators, and partners to explore STEM, digital design, media, and entrepreneurship through a culturally responsive lens. Hub for invention and applied learning, connecting classrooms to careers, and curiosity to creation.
- Wellness Center - Movement, balance, and collective care. Supports the whole educator, the whole student, and the whole family by providing opportunities for physical, emotional, and social well-being.

Building Assessment

- The buildings are currently used as commercial office space. PPS use requires we change the occupancy to an “E” occupancy (educational).

- This change will necessitate additional life safety measures (including seismic and fire suppression). Due to the height of the buildings, the City may limit our classroom use on the upper floors, potentially impacting as much as 15,000sf.

Building Condition & Operations

- **Building Condition:** The buildings are built of mass timber and are approximately ten years old. They are in good overall condition.
  - **HVAC system**: uses a refrigerant that is being phased out and remaining useful life estimated to be five years or less. Given the invasive nature of HVAC replacement, this work should be done in conjunction with the program and occupancy improvements.

- **Building Operations:** The buildings are currently professionally managed. We have reviewed the operating expenses for the buildings, and they are consistent with PPS experience. PPS will continue to engage the property management company through a transition period to be determined post closing.
  - Commercial tenants pay pro rata share of maintenance and property taxes (PPS is exempt from paying property taxes on the portion of the property it uses).

- **Parking:** Parking is limited at the site, and PPS will acquire a portion of a lease for additional parking from the neighboring Life Change Church, which expires in 2027. PPS will work with the Church to extend the term post closing.

Real Property Due Diligence

In addition, PPS staff has concluded the standard due diligence for real property:

- Title Report - no significant issues
- Alta Survey - no significant issues
- Level 1 Environmental Study - level one testing; no significant issues
- Bond Compliance–use of bond funds within statutory authority

Cost & Timing

- The cost for the program and occupancy-related improvements is estimated at $21M-$25M, the cost for the HVAC replacement is estimated at $5.5M, and the purchase price is $16M for a total of $37M-$41M, well within the $60M allocation in the 2020 bond.

- The time for completion of student-facing improvement work is 24-30 months from Board approval.

Next Steps

December 2 Board Meeting:

- Staff will confirm that contingencies can be waived.
- Based on current due diligence findings, staff will recommend that Board approve proceeding with the purchase.



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Questions?

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